BOTANORA

N° 05



Iced & Cold Brew

Cold infusions, foams and summer teas

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BOTANORA · GUIDE N° 05

Iced & Cold Brew

Cold infusions, foams and summer teas

Good iced tea is not hot tea forgotten in the fridge. This guide teaches the methods that keep aroma and sweetness, the right ratios for a one-litre jug, ice that does not water things down, homemade kombucha and almost 40 recipes and mocktails to replace everyday soda.

Almost all recipes use optional sugar or small amounts of homemade syrup. Taste before sweetening: cold already makes tea sweeter.



01

Choose the method

Cold brew for sweetness, flash for aroma.

02

Use the ratio table

One 1 L jug, for each type of tea.

03

Store with care

Iced tea is food: fridge and up to two days.

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CHAPTER I

Methods

Cold, fast or double

There are three reliable ways to make iced tea. Each extracts the leaf differently and gives a different result. Choose by the time you have and the taste you want.

01 The three methods

02 Ratios for 1 litre

03 Safety and storage



CHAPTER I

The three methods

Cold brew

Cold extraction, 6 to 12 h

Leaves in cold water in the fridge. It extracts fewer tannins and less caffeine and more amino acids and sugars: the result is sweet, round and hardly ever bitter.

BEST FOR greens, oolongs, whites, rooibos

Flash (Japanese)

Hot over ice, 3 min

A hot infusion with double the leaf and half the water, strained straight onto ice. It keeps the volatile aromas and gives a lively tea in minutes.

BEST FOR sencha, Darjeeling, florals

Concentrate + dilution

Hot, then cold

A strong infusion in half the volume, sweetened while hot and topped up with iced water or ice. Handy for big jugs and sweetened teas.

BEST FOR blacks, hibiscus, mate

Why does tea turn cloudy?

Strong black tea that cools slowly can turn cloudy, the so-called "tea cream": caffeine and polyphenols bind and form particles. It is harmless but dulls the shine. To avoid it: chill fast over ice, use softer water or choose cold brew.

> **NOT RECOMMENDED**
> Avoid "sun tea" left in the sun for hours. Lukewarm water is the ideal range for bacteria to multiply. Use the fridge.

CHAPTER I

Ratios for 1 litre

Starting points for a 1 L jug. Want it stronger? Add leaf, not time.

TEA	COLD BREW	FRIDGE TIME	FLASH (FOR 1 L)
Green (sencha, Chinese)	8–10 g	6–8 h	20 g · 400 ml at 75 °C · 500 g ice
White	10–12 g	8–10 h	20 g · 400 ml at 85 °C · 500 g ice
Oolong	10 g	10–12 h	20 g · 400 ml at 90 °C · 500 g ice
Black	10 g	8–10 h	16 g · 400 ml boiling · 500 g ice
Hojicha	15 g	6–8 h	20 g · 400 ml boiling · 500 g ice
Yerba mate	20–25 g	2–4 h	–
Rooibos	12 g	8–12 h	20 g · 400 ml boiling · 500 g ice
Hibiscus	15–20 g	4–6 h	25 g · 500 ml boiling · 400 g ice
Chamomile and herbs	12–15 g	8 h	20 g · 400 ml at 95 °C · 500 g ice

BOTANORA TIP

Weigh the ice. In the flash method, hot water plus ice should add up to the final volume: 400 ml water + 500 g ice ≈ 1 L of iced tea at the right temperature.

Measures without scales

TEA	1 TBSP ≈
Rolled leaves (oolong, gunpowder)	5–6 g
Broken-leaf greens and blacks	3–4 g
Whites and large leaves	1,5–2 g
Dried flowers (chamomile, hibiscus)	2–3 g

CHAPTER I

Safety and storage

Iced tea is a moist, low-acid food: treat it as you would fresh juice.

1. **Always in the fridge**, below 5 °C, including during cold brew.
2. **Drink within 2 days.** With fresh fruit, within 24 h.
3. **A clean, scalded jug** with a lid. Wash silicone-sealed lids thoroughly.
4. **Strain the leaves** at the end of the time: leaves left in keep extracting and turn bitter.
5. **A sour smell, sliminess or bubbles** are signs to discard.
6. **Ice is food too:** use filtered water and clean trays.

Sweetening cold

Sugar and honey barely dissolve in cold liquid. Sweeten the concentrate while hot or use syrups (recipes in chapter II). Remember that cold dulls perceived sweetness: taste once chilled before adjusting.

> NOTE
> Honey should not be given to children under 1 year. For them, choose caffeine-free fruit teas without sweetener.

CHAPTER II

Ice and syrups

The supporting cast

Well-planned ice chills without watering down; a homemade syrup sweetens without too much sugar. These details turn an ordinary jug into a café drink.

01 Aromatic ice

02 Homemade syrups



CHAPTER II

Aromatic ice

Freeze the tea itself: the drink stays cold to the end without losing flavour.

Same-tea ice

The basic

Freeze some of the cold brew in trays. Use it in the same tea: as it melts, it only reinforces the flavour.

Hibiscus & honey

Ruby colour

1 tbsp hibiscus, 250 ml boiling water, 1 tbsp honey. Steep 5 min, strain and freeze.

Flowers in ice

For guests

Edible petals, mint or chamomile in boiled and cooled water (it freezes clearer). Freeze in two stages so the flower sits in the middle.

Citrus

Lime and orange

Zest and small pieces of peel (no pith) in filtered water. They perfume the glass bit by bit.

Fruit

For kids

Chopped strawberry, grape or watermelon in diluted juice. At the end they become a snack.

Coffee and milk

For lattes

Milk frozen in cubes for iced matcha or hojicha: the drink gets creamier as it melts.

CHAPTER II

Homemade syrups

They keep up to two weeks in the fridge in a clean glass jar. One tablespoon sweetens 300 ml.

SYRUP	INGREDIENTS	METHOD
Simple	100 g sugar + 100 ml water	Heat until dissolved without boiling hard. Cool.
Honey	100 ml honey + 50 ml warm water	Stir until fluid. Do not boil the honey.
Ginger	Simple + 30 g sliced ginger	Simmer 5 min with the ginger, rest 30 min, strain.
Citrus	Simple + peel of 2 limes	Add the peel to the hot syrup, rest 1 h, strain.
Cinnamon & anise	Simple + 1 cinnamon stick + 2 star anise	Simmer 5 min, store with the spices.
Panela	100 g grated panela + 100 ml water	Dissolve over low heat. Great with mate and black tea.

BOTANORA TIP

To cut sugar, use aromatic syrups: the scent of ginger or cinnamon feels sweet with less sugar.

Garnishes that make a difference

- Twist citrus peel over the glass: the oil lands on the surface.
- Slap mint lightly in your palm before using it.
- A glass chilled in the freezer for 10 minutes keeps everything colder for longer.

CHAPTER III

25 recipes

Jugs, glasses and desserts

Recipes designed for Brazilian heat: from pure cold brews to tonics, fruit teas, colour-changing teas and ice pops. Measures: tsp ≈ 5 ml, tbsp ≈ 15 ml.



N° 01

Black Tea Cold Brew

Smooth, malty, no bitterness.

1 L · CAFFEINATED

10 g	black tea (Ceylon or Assam)
1 L	cold filtered water

Fridge for 8 to 10 h. Strain and serve with ice and lime.

N° 02

Green Cold Brew

Sweet, green, refreshing.

1 L · CAFFEINATED

10 g	sencha or Chinese green
1 L	cold water

Fridge for 6 to 8 h. Strain. Past 10 h it starts to turn bitter.

N° 03

Oolong Cold Brew

Floral and creamy.

1 L · CAFFEINATED

10 g	light oolong (High Mountain, Tie Guan Yin)
1 L	cold water

Fridge for 10 to 12 h. Rolled leaves open slowly in the cold.

N° 04

Iced White Peach

Honey and stone fruit.

1 L · LOW CAFFEINE

10 g	Bai Mu Dan
1	peach, sliced
1 L	cold water

Fridge for 8 h with the peach. Strain and serve with fresh slices.

N° 05

Flash Sencha

Hot over ice: lively aroma in 3 minutes.

300 ML · CAFFEINATED

6 g	sencha
120 ml	water at 75 °C
150 g	ice

Steep 1 min 30 s and strain straight over the ice. Stir.

N° 06

Darjeeling & Grape Cold Brew

Muscatel in a glass, alcohol-free.

1 L · CAFFEINATED

10 g	Darjeeling
1 cup	halved green grapes
1 L	cold water

Fridge for 8 h with the grapes. Strain and serve with frozen grapes instead of ice.

N° 07

Hibiscus & Orange

Ruby, citrusy, caffeine-free.

1 L · CAFFEINE-FREE

3 tbsp	hibiscus flowers
1	orange, sliced
1 L	cold water

Fridge for 6 h. Strain and sweeten to taste with syrup.

N° 08

Blue Tea with Lime

Changes colour in the glass: blue turns purple.

1 L · CAFFEINE-FREE

2 tbsp	dried butterfly pea flower (blue tea)
1 L	cold water
2	limes (juice), at serving

Fridge for 4 h. Strain. Serve blue and add the lime at the table: the acidity changes the colour.

N° 09

Rooibos, Vanilla & Coconut

Creamy, caffeine-free, good for kids.

1 L · CAFFEINE-FREE

3 tbsp	rooibos
½	split vanilla pod
200 ml	coconut milk
800 ml	cold water

Cold brew the rooibos and vanilla for 8 h. Strain and stir in the coconut milk.

N° 10

Mint & Cucumber

A spa in a jug.

1 L · CAFFEINE-FREE

1 sprig	mint
½	cucumber, sliced
1 L	cold water
1 tbsp	green tea (optional)

Fridge for 3 to 4 h. Remove the cucumber after 6 h.

N° 11

Genmaicha Cold Brew

Iced toasted rice: popcorn in a glass.

1 L · LOW CAFFEINE

15 g	genmaicha
1 L	cold water

Fridge for 6 h. Strain. Great with Japanese food and fried dishes.

N° 12

Iced Pu-erh with Orange

Earthy, rounded, surprising when iced.

1 L · CAFFEINATED

10 g	shou pu-erh
1 strip	orange peel
1 L	cold water

Rinse the pu-erh with hot water for 5 s. Then fridge for 10 h with the peel.

N° 13

Green Tea & Watermelon

Sweet, light, the colour of summer.

600 ML · CAFFEINATED

300 ml	green cold brew
300 ml	strained watermelon juice
to taste	mint

Mix just before serving, with plenty of ice.

N° 14

Tea Arnold Palmer

Half tea, half lemonade.

400 ML · CAFFEINATED

200 ml	black tea cold brew
200 ml	lightly sweet lemonade

Ice in the glass, lemonade first and tea on top for layers.

N° 15

Green Tea Tonic

Elegant bitterness, alcohol-free.

300 ML · CAFFEINATED

100 ml	green cold brew
150 ml	tonic water
1 strip	lime peel

Glass full of ice, tea, tonic slowly over a spoon. Twist the peel on top.

N° 16

Hojicha Tonic

Roasted with an elegant bitterness.

1 GLASS · LOW CAFFEINE

80 ml	concentrated hojicha cold brew
150 ml	tonic water
1 wheel	orange

Glass with ice, tonic, hojicha poured slowly on top. Orange to finish.

N° 17

Black Tea & Tamarind

Sweet-sour, tropical, very Brazilian.

1 L · CAFFEINATED

4 bags	black tea
100 g	tamarind pulp
80 ml	panela syrup
1 L	water

Dissolve the tamarind in 300 ml hot water and strain. Steep the tea in 700 ml for 4 min, combine and chill.

N° 18

Homemade Thai Iced Tea

Strong black tea, spices and milk.

300 ML · CAFFEINATED

2 bags	black tea
1	star anise
150 ml	boiling water
2 tbsp	condensed milk or syrup + milk

Steep 5 min with the anise. Sweeten, cool and serve over ice with the milk on top.

N° 19

Hojicha Cold Brew

Toasted caramel, low caffeine.

1 L · LOW CAFFEINE

15 g	hojicha
1 L	cold water

Fridge for 8 h. Great with cold milk.

N° 20

Lavender Lemonade with White Tea

Floral, delicate, party-ready.

1 L · LOW CAFFEINE

600 ml	white tea cold brew
2	lemons (juice)
60 ml	lavender syrup (simple syrup + ½ tsp lavender)
300 ml	iced water

Mix everything and serve over ice with a lavender sprig.

N° 21

Lemon Balm & Green Apple

Herbal, tart, caffeine-free.

1 L · CAFFEINE-FREE

1 handful	fresh lemon balm
1	green apple, sliced
1 L	cold water

Bruise the lemon balm and chill with the apple for 6 h. Strain.

N° 22

Red Berries

Rosehip, hibiscus and berries.

1 L · CAFFEINE-FREE

3 bags	red berry tea
1 cup	strawberries or berries
1 L	cold water

Fridge for 6 h with the fruit lightly crushed.

N° 23

Green Tea & Kiwi

Green on green, tart and fresh.

600 ML · CAFFEINATED

400 ml	green cold brew
2	ripe kiwis
1 tbsp	honey

Blend the kiwis with the honey, strain and mix into the tea. Serve over ice.

N° 24

Tea Cold Foam

A topping for any iced drink.

2 SERVINGS

60 ml	very cold skimmed milk
1 tsp	syrup
1 pinch	matcha or cinnamon

Blend with a hand frother or shake in a closed jar for 30 s. Spoon over the iced tea.

N° 25

Tea Ice Pops

Dessert for the hottest days.

6 POPS

400 ml	any cold brew from this guide
3 tbsp	syrup or honey
to taste	chopped fruit

Sweeten a little more than usual (cold dulls sweetness), fill with the fruit and freeze for 6 h.

Cold asks for more leaf, more patience and less sugar.

CHAPTER IV

Kombucha

Fermented tea at home

Kombucha is sweetened tea fermented by a colony of bacteria and yeast (the SCOBY). The result is a tart, lightly sparkling and very versatile drink. With hygiene and patience it is simple to make.

01 What you need

02 First fermentation

03 Second fermentation and flavours



KOMBUCHA

What you need

ITEM	FOR 2 L	NOTE
Black or green tea	12–16 g (6 to 8 bags)	No flavourings or oils: they harm the SCOBY
Granulated sugar	140–160 g	Food for the yeast, not the drinker: most is consumed
Filtered water	2 L	Chlorine-free
Starter liquid	200–300 ml	Plain finished kombucha; it acidifies and protects
SCOBY	1 disc	Get one from a brewer or a trusted supplier
Glass jar	3 L, wide mouth	No metal, scratched plastic or lead-glazed ceramic
Cloth and band	1	Tight-weave fabric: lets air in and keeps flies out
Swing-top bottles	4 of 500 ml	Thick glass, made for pressure

WHO SHOULD AVOID IT

Not recommended for pregnant or breastfeeding people, young children or the immunocompromised. Homemade kombucha can contain traces of alcohol (usually below 1%) and is very acidic: start with half a glass a day.

KOMBUCHA

First fermentation

7 to 14 days, at 22 to 26 °C, out of the sun.

1. **Wash everything** in hot water and rinse with vinegar. Clean hands, no soap residue.
2. **Make the tea:** boil 500 ml of water, steep the tea 10 min, strain and dissolve the sugar.
3. **Top up with 1.5 L of cold water** and wait until it is at room temperature. Hot tea kills the SCOBY.
4. **Add the starter liquid and the SCOBY.** Cover with the cloth and secure with the band.
5. **Wait without stirring.** From day 7, taste with a straw: it is ready when lightly tart and still a little sweet.
6. **Set aside 300 ml and the SCOBY** for the next batch. The rest goes into bottles.

Normal or a problem?

YOU SEE	WHAT IT IS
A new pale film on the surface	Normal: the new SCOBY forming
Brown strands hanging	Normal: yeast
Bubbles trapped under the SCOBY	Normal: active fermentation
Fuzzy, dry, green, black or blue spots on top	Mould: throw everything out, SCOBY included
Very strong vinegar smell	Over-fermented: use as vinegar or starter

KOMBUCHA

Second fermentation and flavours

In sealed bottles, with fruit: this is where fizz and flavour are born.

1. Put the fruit or juice in the bottle (10 to 15% of the volume) and fill with kombucha, leaving 3 cm free.
2. Close and leave 1 to 3 days at room temperature.
3. Open once a day carefully, over the sink, to release pressure.
4. Once fizzy, move to the fridge. Drink within 2 weeks.

FLAVOUR	PER 500 ML BOTTLE
Ginger and lime	1 tbsp grated ginger + 1 tbsp lime juice
Strawberry and basil	4 crushed strawberries + 3 basil leaves
Pineapple and mint	60 ml pineapple juice + 4 mint leaves
Hibiscus and orange	1 tsp hibiscus + 1 strip orange peel
Passion fruit	Pulp of 1 passion fruit
Grape	60 ml pure grape juice

PRESSURE

Ordinary or thin bottles can burst under pressure. Use glass made for carbonation, do not fill to the top and never forget bottles outside the fridge.

26 Real Peach Iced Tea

The canned flavour, made with real fruit and tea.

Iced · 25 min · 1 jug · 1 L · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

2	ripe peaches (or 4 canned halves, drained)
60 g	sugar
100 ml	water
4 bags	black tea
500 ml	boiling water
400 g	ice
½	lemon (juice)

Finish. Peach slices and mint.

METHOD

1. Cook the chopped peach with the sugar and 100 ml water for 10 min. Mash and strain: that is the syrup.
2. Steep the tea in the boiling water for 4 min.
3. Add the syrup and lemon to the hot tea.
4. Pour over the ice in the jug and stir.

BARISTA TIP The syrup keeps 1 week in the fridge: make double.

27 Green Tea Brazilian Lemonade

Brazil's creamy lemonade, with green cold brew.

Iced · 5 min · 4 glasses · Caffeinated · With milk · Easy

INGREDIENTS

2	washed limes, peel on
600 ml	green tea cold brew
4 tbsp	condensed milk or syrup
1 cup	ice

METHOD

1. Quarter the limes and remove the white core.
2. Blend everything for 10 s at most.
3. Strain immediately and serve.

BARISTA TIP Blending longer than 10 s releases the bitterness of the peel. Serve at once: it turns bitter within 20 minutes.

28 Hibiscus & Ginger Punch

For parties, alcohol- and caffeine-free.

Iced · 20 min · 1 punch bowl · 2 L · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

6 tbsp	hibiscus
40 g	sliced ginger
1 L	water
120 ml	simple syrup
2	oranges, sliced
1 L	chilled sparkling water

Finish. Hibiscus ice (chapter II).

METHOD

1. Simmer the ginger in the water for 5 min. Turn off, add the hibiscus and steep 10 min.
2. Strain, sweeten and chill.
3. At serving time: ice, orange and sparkling water.

BARISTA TIP Add the fizz only at the last moment so the bubbles survive.

29 Iced Earl Grey with Lavender

Bergamot and flowers, served with honey.

Iced · 5 min + 8 h · 1 jug · 1 L · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

10 g	Earl Grey
½ tsp	culinary lavender
1 L	cold water
3 tbsp	honey syrup

Finish. A lemon wheel.

METHOD

1. Cold brew the tea with the lavender for 8 h.
2. Strain and sweeten with the honey syrup.

BARISTA TIP Too much lavender tastes of soap: start with half a teaspoon.

30 Black Tea & Lemon Granita

A fork-scraped dessert.

Iced · 10 min + 4 h · 6 glasses · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

500 ml	strong black tea
100 g	sugar
1	lemon (juice and zest)

Finish. A spoon of whipped cream.

METHOD

1. Dissolve the sugar in the hot tea, add lemon juice and zest. Cool.
2. Pour into a shallow tray and freeze.
3. Every 30 min, scrape with a fork for 3 to 4 h, until it becomes loose crystals.

BARISTA TIP Works with any cold brew in this guide; hibiscus and matcha are great.

31 Green Tea & Coconut Ice Pops

Creamy, green and tropical.

Iced · 10 min + 6 h · 6 pops · Caffeinated · With milk · Easy

INGREDIENTS

200 ml	concentrated green cold brew
200 ml	coconut milk
60 g	sugar
2 tbsp	grated coconut

METHOD

1. Dissolve the sugar in the warm coconut milk.
2. Stir in the tea and grated coconut.
3. Pour into moulds and freeze 6 h.

BARISTA TIP The fat in the coconut milk keeps the pop soft and creamy, without crystals.

32 Tropical Green Smoothie

Green tea, pineapple and mint.

Iced · 5 min · 2 glasses · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

200 ml	green tea cold brew
2 cups	frozen pineapple chunks
8 leaves	mint
1 tbsp	honey

METHOD

1. Blend until smooth.
2. Taste and adjust the honey.

BARISTA TIP Frozen fruit instead of ice: the smoothie turns creamy, not watery.

33 Black Tea Affogato

Vanilla ice cream drowned in very strong black tea.

Hot · 5 min · 2 glasses · Caffeinated · With milk · Easy

INGREDIENTS

2 scoops	vanilla ice cream
6 g	Assam or Keemun black tea
80 ml	boiling water
1 tsp	brown sugar

Finish. Crumbled shortbread.

METHOD

1. Steep the tea in little water for 5 min: a tea "espresso".
2. Strain and dissolve the sugar.
3. Pour hot over the ice cream in chilled glasses.

BARISTA TIP Use double the leaf and half the water: the flavour has to stand up to the ice cream.

FOR ENTERTAINING

Iced tea bar

For birthdays, barbecues and parties: three jugs, a table of add-ins and everyone builds their own.

GUESTS	READY TEA	DRY LEAF	ICE
10	4 L	40–50 g	3 kg
20	8 L	80–100 g	6 kg
40	15 L	150–180 g	12 kg

Three jugs

One caffeinated (black or green), one caffeine-free (hibiscus or rooibos) and one "special" (peach or oolong).

Add-ins

Sliced fruit, mint, basil, syrups in small bottles, aromatic ice and sparkling water.

The day before

Make the cold brews and syrups, freeze the ice and label everything.

BOTANORA TIP

Small "caffeinated" and "caffeine-free" labels save questions and protect children and anyone avoiding caffeine.

FOR ENTERTAINING

Six tea mocktails

N° 01

White Tea Spritz

Pear, bubbles and white tea.

1 GLASS

100 ml	white tea cold brew
80 ml	sparkling water
3	thin pear slices

Glass with ice and pear, tea, fizz on top.

N° 02

Green Tea Mojito

Mint, lime and green tea.

1 GLASS

8	mint leaves
½	lime in wedges
1 tbsp	syrup
150 ml	green cold brew

Muddle mint, lime and syrup; ice and tea.

N° 03

Oolong & Passion Fruit

Tropical and floral.

1 GLASS

150 ml	oolong cold brew
1	passion fruit (pulp)
1 tbsp	syrup

Shake everything with ice in a closed jar.

N° 04

Black Tea Sour

Foam, lemon and tea.

1 GLASS

120 ml	strong cold black tea
30 ml	lemon juice
20 ml	syrup
1	pasteurised egg white or aquafaba

Shake without ice, then with ice. Strain.

N° 05

Rooibos Cola

Caffeine-free, with spices.

1 GLASS

100 ml	iced rooibos with cinnamon
20 ml	panela syrup
100 ml	sparkling water

Ice, rooibos, syrup and fizz.

N° 06

Jasmine & Lychee

Delicate, party-worthy.

1 GLASS

120 ml	jasmine cold brew
3	crushed lychees
60 ml	tonic water

Lychees at the bottom, ice, tea and tonic.

FOR ENTERTAINING

Less sugar, same pleasure

A regular soda has about 35 g of sugar per can. The teas in this guide range from 0 to 12 g per glass.

SWEETENER	HOW TO USE	PAIRS WITH
Ripe fruit	Crushed into the cold brew or as syrup	blacks, whites, hibiscus
Honey	As syrup (2:1 with warm water)	herbs, greens, Earl Grey
Panela and brown sugar	As syrup	mate, chai, rooibos
Stevia and erythritol	Dissolved into the hot concentrate	hibiscus and fruity teas
Sweet spices	Cinnamon, vanilla, anise in the brew	almost all

Weaning off in four weeks

WEEK	SUGAR PER LITRE
1	80 g
2	60 g
3	40 g
4	20 g or none

Your palate adapts within a few weeks. Cutting back gradually works better than stopping all at once, and cold brew, naturally sweeter, helps a lot in the transition.



Thank you for brewing with us

The Botanora collection has ten guides, each devoted to one way of living with tea. Keep exploring:

01 Signature Infusions
02 The Tea Atlas
03 The Night Ritual
04 Focus & Energy
06 Matcha at Home
07 Backyard Herbs
08 Crafting Blends
09 Tea & Table
10 Yerba Mate

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